

Nielsen Norman Group

Heuristic Evaluation

Workbook

Use this workbook to conduct your own heuristic evaluation.

For each of Jakob's 10 Usability Heuristics, look for specific places where the interface fails to adhere to the guideline. Write your recommendations for how to fix those usability issues.

<https://www.nngroup.com/articles/ten-usability-heuristics/>

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Evaluator:

Date:

Product:

Task:



Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

- Does the design clearly communicate its
- state? Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?
 -

2

Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

- Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design? Do the design's
- controls follow real-world conventions?
 -

Issues

Screen: Home screen

On the Home screen, the bottom navigation bar displays the "Search" icon (magnifying glass) as the currently active tab; however, the content displayed on the page corresponds to the "Explore" dashboard instead of an actual search interface.

Recommendations

The active state of each navigation icon in the bottom navigation bar should accurately reflect and correspond to the page content currently being displayed on the screen.

Issues

N/A

Recommendations

N/A

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User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action? Is
- *Undo* and *Redo* supported?

Issues

N/A

Recommendations

N/A

4

Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?

Issues

A naming inconsistency was observed between two screens the header of one screen labels the section as "Popular Places," whereas the home dashboard refers to the same content as "Best Destination," resulting in inconsistent terminology across the interface.

Recommendations

Button components and terminology should be unified and consistently applied throughout all screens for instance, selecting either "Places" or "Destinations" as the standard label in order to preserve a cohesive and professional appearance across the entire interface.

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Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

Issues

N/A

Recommendations

N/A

6

Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it? ● Does the design offer help in-context?

Issues

N/A

Recommendations

N/A

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Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts — hidden from novice users — may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and functionality personalized or customized for individual users?

Issues

N/A

Recommendations

N/A

8

Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnecessary elements been removed?

Issues

N/A

Recommendations

N/A

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Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

10 Help and

Documentation

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation.

However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

Issues

Missing Empty States: If a user views "My Schedule" on a day with no trips, the screen might appear broken rather than simply empty.

Implicit Errors: There is no clear feedback if a search for an attraction fails; the map simply remains static.

Recommendations

Constructive Empty States: If no schedule exists for October 22, display a friendly message like "No trips today! Explore new destinations to add them to your schedule."

Visual Error Cues: Use traditional error styling, such as red text or a specific icon, if a user attempts to "Set Schedule" without selecting a valid date.

Issues

Contextual Help: There are no "tooltips" or onboarding prompts to explain how to use the interactive map or the schedule sync.

Recommendations

Onboarding Tips: When a user first opens the Map, provide a one-time "coach mark" or tooltip pointing to the "View Maps" button to explain its function right at the moment they need it.